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Everything About Spatula and What Happened This Week and Some Other Things Too

A very long update about the cat, errands, weather, Halloween, losing things, finding things, and whatever else came to mind.

Posted by Spatula's Person | 38 minute read | Updated after dinner

So This Is What Happened on Monday

Monday started with coffee that I forgot on the counter because the laundry buzzer went off, and then I remembered that the blue basket was still in the car from Saturday, which reminded me that I never returned the library book about houseplants. While I was looking for my keys, the orange cat sat in the hallway staring at the closet door as if something very important were happening inside it. The closet only contains coats, a vacuum cleaner, and a bag of batteries, but the cat stayed there for almost twenty minutes. It rained sometime after lunch, although the forecast said the rain would arrive in the morning, and I made a sandwich that had too much mustard because the bottle poured faster than expected. None of this explains the title, but it was the first part of the week and therefore seemed like the place to begin.

I should probably explain somewhere that **Spatula is my cat**. Her name is Spatula because when she was a kitten she stretched out flat on the kitchen floor beside the drawer where the spatulas are kept, and the name seemed funny at the time. People sometimes think the website is about cooking utensils, which is understandable because I used a picture of a pancake turner on the first version of the home page and never changed the description. Spatula is orange, likes cardboard boxes, dislikes the vacuum cleaner, and can hear a treat container from the opposite end of the house even though she occasionally pretends not to hear her name. I meant to write a short introduction about her, but then the mail arrived and one envelope was addressed to the previous resident, so I spent several minutes wondering how long mail forwarding lasts.



Spatula the cat wears a wizard hat while two neighbor dogs pose in Halloween costumes. This is one of forty-three pictures.

The Time Spatula Got Lost, Plus Other Details

Last spring Spatula got lost for nearly four hours, although “lost” may be the wrong word because she apparently knew exactly where she was. I had opened the back door to move a plant into the sun, and sometime between carrying the plant and answering a phone call, Spatula slipped onto the porch and disappeared. I searched beneath the deck, walked around the block twice, shook the treat container, asked three neighbors, checked the laundry room even though I had already checked it, and printed a sign without a recent photograph because the printer would not connect to the wireless network. The entire time, Spatula was sleeping inside an empty storage bin behind the garden hose. She came out when a delivery truck stopped nearby, stretched, and looked annoyed that everyone was making so much noise.

The search made me late for an appointment, which led to taking a different road, which led to discovering that the bakery near the hardware store sells cinnamon rolls on Thursdays. I bought two even though it was Friday because apparently they also sell them on Friday, and then I stopped for gasoline and could not remember which side of the car has the fuel door. When I got home, Spatula ignored me and sat in the window. I moved the storage bin indoors, but it is still in the hallway because I have not decided what belongs in it. It currently contains string, a flashlight without batteries, two paper bags, and a Halloween napkin from last year.

Halloween Costume Pictures and the Grocery Store

For Halloween I bought Spatula a small purple wizard hat. The package said it was designed for cats, but the elastic loop was too long, the brim tilted over one ear, and Spatula remained interested only because I placed treats beside the camera. The photograph below includes two dogs from next door because they came over while we were trying to take the picture. One dog wore a ghost costume and the other wore a pumpkin bandana, and everyone looked at the camera for exactly one second before Spatula attempted to investigate the hat string. I took forty-three photographs, forgot to delete the blurry ones, and later spent half an hour trying to remember the password for the folder where I saved them.

Afterward I went to the grocery store for milk and came home with soup, paper towels, a tiny pumpkin, and no milk. The parking lot was full, the shopping cart had one wheel that made a clicking sound, and someone had moved the crackers to a different aisle. I saw a silicone spatula near the seasonal display and briefly considered buying it because it was orange like Spatula the cat, but we already own several kitchen spatulas and at least one of them is probably in the drawer beneath the oven. Spatula slept in the grocery bag until dinner, which reminded me to add “put away groceries” to a list that I had already misplaced.

A Few More Things Before I Forget Them

The hallway light still flickers on cold mornings, the oldest mug still has a chip near the handle, and the basil plant needs water more often than I expect. Spatula knocked a pen beneath the refrigerator yesterday and watched me retrieve it with a ruler. Then she sat on the ruler. I was going to explain what food she likes, but the answer changes whenever I buy a large package, and that subject deserves its own page once I find the notes I made. There are also three boxes in the living room because she likes the smallest one, but I am keeping the other two in case she changes her mind. The weather tomorrow may be sunny, unless the forecast changes again.

In conclusion, Spatula is still a cat, the Halloween hat is now in a drawer, the library book has been returned, and I eventually found the blue laundry basket beneath a coat in the car. This post was supposed to be a short update about Spatula, but there were many other details that seemed important while I was typing. I may add more later, especially if I remember what happened on Wednesday or find the photograph of Spatula sitting beside the pancake turner. For now, the cat is asleep, the coffee is cold, and the storage bin remains in the hallway.

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